

line methods, as the UI-based Network Manager in Lucid is reported to have several issues. See [4] for detailed instructions on how to do this.

While following the procedure, we recommend that you assign a high address number for your laptop, to ensure that the DHCP-served (by the ADSL router) addresses (which start at the lower end of the range) do not create an IP address conflict with another system. In our scenario, we have used the IP address 192.168.1.250.

SSH server on the laptop

This is one of many services that enable remote connection to your system. We installed OpenSSH [5] for Ubuntu Lucid, with the following command:

```
$rg@laila: sudo apt-get install openssh-server
```

The SSH service on the laptop was left at the default configuration, listening on port 22, since it is on a private network and not directly accessible to the Internet.

Firewall configuration on the laptop

If you have a firewall set up on the laptop, remember to allow access to the SSH service, using *iptables* or other equivalent but more friendly options. We use the *ufw* (uncomplicated firewall) [6] command in Ubuntu to open the SSH port, 22:

```
$rg@laila: sudo ufw allow 22
Sample result:
Rule updated
```

Choose an external port number for the router

While the easy approach might be to use the same SSH port 22 in the forwarding rule as the port to connect to on the router's public (Internet) interface, this is a bad idea. Crackers and others routinely have automated probes checking well-known ports such as 22, 80, 3306, etc, to see if they are open, and then attempt various attacks on them. To avoid this happening to your home network, choose a non-standard arbitrary high number for the port (ours is 10102).

Set up a port-forwarding rule on the router

With the above configuration done, you now know the information required to set up the port-forwarding rule, so go ahead and do that.

Install client software on an Android phone

In our case, we installed ConnectBot [7], which is a simple-to-install SSH client for Google Android-powered phones. The download is straightforward, and you can choose a stable release from the list. After installation, ConnectBot appears as a nice desktop icon, with fancy short-cuts, and maintains a command history.

One of the most useful features is its support for SSH key-



Figure 1: Connecting to the laptop from ConnectBot



Figure 2: Authenticated SSH session